

within a specific niche and sell products only within a particular category thereby positioning themselves as a knowledge leader. As niche websites operate only within a single sector, they are able to stock more brands and a wider range of products in that segment as compared to what a horizontal website such as Yebhi or Flipkart would. This results in a chain reaction of the site gaining more eyeballs as wouldn't you rather purchase a camera from a camera shop rather than from a generic departmental store?

The Indian market, which was till now flooded with multi-product e-commerce sites is now seeing new ventures that are betting big on niche categories. For example, there is Lenskart.com for eyewear, Bagskart.com for bags, Zimave.com for lingerie, BeStylish.com for shoes and Jewelsnext.com for jewelry. As the e-commerce industry in India starts to get crowded, newer players are looking for areas, which have not been touched widely. Consequently, niche sites are emerging mostly in two categories – fashion and healthcare.

The vertical marketplace model “has a bright prospect for the future and is as viable as multi-brand outlets are in the offline world. The aim with such a model is to become the one-stop destination for connoisseur's within a particular category”, says Shailen Amin, CEO and Co-founder, BeStylish.com.

In India, just like the traditional retail world, both the online mega mall and niche websites will continue to co-exist and grow simultaneously because people looking for multiple products will go with



players that operate horizontally while those looking for more varieties in one segment will go for the niche players.

According to the Internet & Mobile Association of India, there are roughly 360 e-commerce sites operational in the country and in recent months almost 30 – 45 new ventures have come up that cater only to single verticals. Check out some of these other niche sites:

- Allschoolstuff.com for all types of educational products
- Heavenandhome.com for home furnishings